



French 101: Say What Is Not Happening

College • French

Course objective

Form and interpret present-tense negation with *ne/n' ... pas*. Includes 16 practice tasks, a four-task exit check, two explained models, and complete answer guidance.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan a focused lesson

Level and alignment

College • French; Course objective. Focus: Form and interpret present-tense negation with *ne/n'* ... *pas*.

What is included

One cover; one teacher guide; one mini-lesson with two explained models; 1 original text/reference section(s); 16 practice tasks on four pages; one four-task exit check; four answer-key pages covering all 20 tasks; two access/source/license pages. Student texts are original, not extracted from released tests.

Time and sequence

Two 30–40-minute sessions plus a 10–15-minute exit check; extended writing or speech rehearsal may take longer. Model first; use tasks 1–4 to check readiness; practice the remainder in short groups; give tasks 17–20 without the key.

Preparation

Print student pages separately from teacher pages. Provide pencils and extra paper; oral-response learners need an adult recorder. Review word meanings and prerequisite decoding or sentence skills. No paid app, novel, or external reading is required.

Student directions

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.



Learn the move

In the written forms practiced here, place *ne* before the conjugated verb and *pas* after it. Before a vowel or mute *h*, *ne* becomes *n'*. Keep the verb conjugation. Ordinary spoken French sometimes drops *ne*; this packet practices the full written form. The supplied sentences avoid indefinite/partitive-object changes so the focus stays on placement. This independent French 101 resource claims no accreditation, transfer, or equivalency.

Model 1 • Negate: Tu parles français.

Tu ne parles pas français. Put *ne/pas* around *parles*.

Model 2 • Negate: Elle aime lire.

Elle n'aime pas lire. *Aime* starts with a vowel; *lire* remains an infinitive after the conjugated verb.

Try the task first. Then compare the reasoning, not just the final word.



Support bank

je = I; tu = you (singular informal); il/elle = he/she; nous = we; vous = you (formal/plural); ils/elles = they. parler = speak; travailler = work; habiter = live; aimer = like; écouter = listen; lire = read. aujourd'hui = today; ici = here; demain = tomorrow; souvent = often. Keep definite le/la/les in these examples.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

1. Negate: Je parle allemand.

2. Negate: Tu travailles ici.

3. Negate: Elle habite à Paris.

4. Negate: Nous aimons le théâtre.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

5. Negate: Vous écoutez la radio.

6. Negate: Ils arrivent demain.

7. Negate: Je suis prêt.

8. Negate: Elles sont ici.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

9. Fix: Tu pas parles français.

10. Fix: Elle ne aime pas lire.

11. Fix: Nous ne travaillons ici pas.

12. Fix: Je n'suis pas prêt.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

13. Translate: Vous ne travaillez pas aujourd’hui.

14. Translate: Ils n’habitent pas ici.

15. Write the negative in French: She likes the music. Use Elle aime la musique.

16. Explain why n’ appears in n’écoutez but ne appears in ne parlez.



Exit check • Apply the skill

Try without the answer key. Show evidence or reasoning when asked. Use separate paper for longer responses.

17. Negate: Nous sommes prêts.

18. Negate: Tu aimes le cinéma.

19. Translate: Je ne parle pas espagnol.

20. Negate: Elles écoutent la musique. Explain placement.



Answers and response criteria

1. Je ne parle pas allemand.
2. Tu ne travailles pas ici.
3. Elle n'habite pas à Paris. H in habite is mute.
4. Nous n'aimons pas le théâtre.
5. Vous n'écoutez pas la radio.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

6. Ils n'arrivent pas demain.

7. Je ne suis pas prêt.

8. Elles ne sont pas ici.

9. Tu ne parles pas français.

10. Elle n'aime pas lire.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

11. Nous ne travaillons pas ici.

12. Je ne suis pas prêt. Suis starts with a consonant sound.

13. You are not working today / You do not work today. Vous may be formal singular or plural.

14. They do not live here.

15. Elle n'aime pas la musique. Keep la, a definite article.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

16. Écoutez begins with a vowel; parlez begins with a consonant sound.

17. Nous ne sommes pas prêts.

18. Tu n'aimes pas le cinéma.

19. I do not speak Spanish.

20. Elles n'écoutent pas la musique. N' precedes the vowel-initial conjugated verb; pas follows it.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Access and next teaching steps

AIG

Ask for a counterexample, an alternative supported interpretation, or a newly written item with an explanation. Add depth rather than speed.

504

Follow the individual plan: breaks, enlarged print, extra time, reduced copying, or an alternative response method as documented. These are classroom options, not a statement of permitted test accommodations.

EC

Follow the IEP; show one task at a time, model the first decision, and permit dictated reasoning when appropriate. For decoding practice, distinguish an adult-read direction from an adult-read target word.

ESL

Preview task verbs and key vocabulary, allow home-language planning, and offer “My answer is ___ because ___.” Evaluate the targeted skill separately from unrelated language errors. For French, retain the target French sentence while explaining directions in a familiar language.

Use the exit evidence

For each exit task, record 2 = accurate and complete for the stated prompt; 1 = partly accurate or missing a requested explanation; 0 = not yet demonstrated. Total 0–8 is a local teaching note, not a standardized score. For oral tasks do not penalize spelling or handwriting. Revisit the exact type of error rather than assigning a diagnostic label.

Next lesson: model one missed decision, let the learner try a new example, and compare the explanation. Extend only after the learner can explain the targeted skill.

Alignment, sources, and license

Introductory college course-level skill practice; no accreditation, guaranteed transfer, credential, or universal course equivalency is claimed.

University teaching reference • accessed September 15, 2026

<https://laits.utexas.edu/tex/gr/neg2.html>

Print US Letter at actual size. Text is selectable; enlarging or digital annotation is optional. This is not a tagged-accessibility-certified or fillable PDF. Keep teacher keys separate. No certified Lexile score is claimed.

Single-teacher license: the purchaser may make copies for their own students and use the file in a restricted class LMS. No resale, public posting, sharing of complete files, or redistribution. Original passages, questions, and teaching explanations; official standards and reference sources retain their owners' rights. No agency endorsement. Official store logo reused unchanged.

PRIVATE DRAFT • Not approved for sale or customer distribution. © 2026 Saint Pierre Learning Resources.

